Story of the Flood (*Atraḫasīs*) – Middle Babylonian Bab$_2$: "… […]"

▼ Contents

1' 2
2' 2
3' 2
4' 2
5' 2
6' 3
7' 3
8' 3
9' 3
10' 4
11' 4
12' 4
13' 4
14' 5
15' 5
16' 5
17' 5
18'a 5
18'b 6
19' 6
20' 6
21'a 6
21'b 7
22' 7
23' 7

- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/1/Middle%20Babylonian/Bab%E2%82%82
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/1/chapters/Middle%20Babylonian/Bab%E2%82%82/display
- Edition:

- Translation:
- Generated by `tools/ebl_fetch.py` on 2026-10-16 – do not edit by hand; re-run the tool instead.

Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1'

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
BabMBSch1 o 1'. x [...]
```

2'

- **N:** ilū | … […]
- **T:** The gods … […]
- **L:** *ilū* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”

```
BabMBSch1 o 2'. DINGIR-MEŠ x [...]
```

3'

- **N:** ellil | irtē[q? | …]
- **T:** Ellil was free *of work* […]
- **L:** *ellil* ← Ellil I “”; *irtē[q?* ← riāqu I “to be empty”

```
BabMBSch1 o 3'. <{d}>50 ir-<<ir>>-te-eq?# [x x x x x x]
```

4'

- **N:** ilū | dulla | izabbil[ū]
- **T:** The gods had been bearing the work…
- **L:** *ilū* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *dulla* ← dullu I “pl. m. & f. trouble”; *izabbil[ū]* ← zabālu I “to carry, deliver”

```
BabMBSch1 o 4'. i-lu du-ul-la i-za#-bi#-l[u]
```

5'

- **N:** ašbū-ma | ikkalū | karṣī | utta[zzamū]
- **T:** (Then) they convened and began to complain (and) grumble:

- **L:** *ašbū-ma* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *ikkalū* ← akālu I “to eat”; *karṣī* ← karṣu I “slander Bab., NA *k. akālu(m)* to slander, *ākil k.*, Mari *ša k.…*”; *utta[zzamū]* ← nazāmu I “to moan, complain Ass., O/jB”

```
BabMBSch1 o 5'. aš-bu-ma ik-ka-lu kar-ṣi | ut-ta-[(az)-za-mu]
```

6'

- **N:** tupšikku(m)-ma | iddūknâši || kabit | dull[u]
- **T:** “The toil indeed is killing us, hard is the work,
- **L:** *tupšikku(m)-ma* ← tupšikku I “pl. f. brick-carrying frame”; *iddūknâši* ← dâku I “to kill”; *kabit* ← kabātu I “to be(come) heavy”; *dull[u]* ← dullu I “pl. m. & f. trouble”

```
BabMBSch1 o 6'. tup-ši-ik-ku-ma GAZ-na-ši ka-bit# du-ul#-l[u*]
```

7'

- **N:** <m>ād | šapšaqni
- **T:** Too much our distress!
- **L:** *<m>ād* ← mâdu I “to be(come) many, numerous”; *šapšaqni* ← šapšāqu I “constraint, hardship Bab.(lit.) of human condition(s)”

```
BabMBSch1 o 7'. <ma>-a-ad# šap-ša#-aq-ni
```

8'

- **N:** alkāni | guzalâni | i ninēram-ma!
- **T:** Come, let us slay our steward, …
- **L:** *alkāni* ← alāku I “to go”; *guzalâni* ← guzalû I “OB pl. f. chair-carrier, throne-bearer O/jB OB (an official)”; *i* ← i I “let's”; *ninēram-ma!* ← nêru I “to strike”

```
BabMBSch1 o 8'. al-ka-ni {giš}gu-za-la-ni i ni-<ne₂>-ri-am-ma
```

9'

- **N:** u kabta | dullani || i nišbir | nīr[ni]
- **T:** and break our heavy work, our yoke!’
- **L:** *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *kabta* ← kabtu I “f. *kabittu(m)* heavy”; *dullani* ← dullu I “pl. m. & f. trouble”; *i* ← i I “let's”; *nišbir* ← šebēru I “to break”; *nīr[ni]* ← nīru I “yoke, crossbeam”
- **Note:** [RN59aa: 170, 173] restore *i ni-iš-h[u?-uṭ]* from the verb *šahāṭu* “to cast off”. On the “sandwiching” of the verb between two accusatives, a well-attested device in Babylonian literature, see the remarks in [marquezrowe2016middle: 62].

```
BabMBSch1 o 9'. u₃ ka-ab-ta du-ul-la-ni i-ni-iš-bir₅ ni-ir-[ni]
```

10'

- **N:** (w)ê | ša īšû || ilu | ṭēma
- **T:** (Then) (W)e, the god who took the initiative,
- **L:** *(w)ê* ← We I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *īšû* ← išû I “to have (no pres., pret. *īši*, *īšu*”; *ilu* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *ṭēma* ← ṭēmu I “pl. m. & f. (fore)thought, plan(ning)”
- **Note:** On the name “(W)ê” of the god leader of the rebellion, previously interpreted by most scholars as Wê-ila or Aw-ila, see the commentary on this line in [marquezrowe2016middle: 62] (following [krebernik2002geschlachtet: 290]). [RN59aa: 173-74] read *UN* at the beginning. The epithet *ša išû ilu ṭēma* displays the same word order as in OB II 103, which shows that the two texts were closely related.

```
BabMBSch1 o 10'. <{d}>e ša i-šu-u₂ i-lu ṭe-ma
```

11'

- **N:** pâšu | <ī>pušam-ma || ana ilī | [i]zzaqqar
- **T:** Opened his mouth and addressed the gods:
- **L:** *pâšu* ← pû I “(also OB)”; *<ī>pušam-ma* ← epēšu II “to do”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *[i]zzaqqar* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”

```
BabMBSch1 o 11'. pa#-a-šu# <i>-pu-ša!-[m]a ana DINGIR#-MEŠ [i]z-za-qar
```

12'

- **N:** i nimhaṣ-ma | guzalâ | labī<rū>ti
- **T:** Let us smite the steward of old time,
- **L:** *i* ← i I “let's”; *nimhaṣ-ma* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”; *guzalâ* ← guzalû I “OB pl. f. chair-carrier, throne-bearer O/jB OB (an official)”; *labī<rū>ti* ← labīru I “old of objects, food, drink etc.”

```
BabMBSch1 r 1. i# ni#-im-ha-aṣ-ma {giš}GU.ZA.LA₂?# la?#-bi-<ru>-ti
```

13'

- **N:** [...] ... | išakkan | ellil
- **T:** Enlil will appoint ...
- **L:** *išakkan* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”; *ellil* ← Ellil I “”

```
BabMBSch1 r 2. [i?-š]u-tu?# x (x) x i-ša-ka!-an <{d}>en-lil₂
```

14'

- **N:** … […] | išakkan
- **T:** … […] will appoint
- **L:** *išakkan* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”

```
BabMBSch1 r 3. i#-šu-x [(x)] x i-ša-ka-an <<nu>>
```

15'

- **N:** … […] … | ina mahrīni | ila | lemna?
- **T:** … in front of us … the *evil god*,
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *mahrīni* ← mahru II “front”; *ila* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *lemna?* ← lemnu I “f. *le/amuttu(m)* bad person, demon, animal”

```
BabMBSch1 r 4. NE?# x [x] x i#-na mah#-ri-ni DINGIR lem?#-na
```

16'

- **N:** … || unninī | alkāni
- **T:** … *will hear my* plea. Come,
- **L:** *unninī* ← unnīnu I “supplication, petition OAkk, Bab., NA *u. leqû(m)* of deity, king…”; *alkāni* ← alāku I “to go”

```
BabMBSch1 r 5. x x x x-mu-u un-ni-ni al-ka-ni
```

17'

- **N:** … | [n]išebbira | nīrni
- **T:** … we shall break our yoke,
- **L:** *[n]išebbira* ← šebēru I “to break”; *nīrni* ← nīru I “yoke, crossbeam”
- **Note:** Compare line 8′ above: *u kabta dullāni i nišbir nīr*[*ni*] (see [marquezrowe2016middle: 64], who reads *al?#-ka?#-<ni?> [i? n]u?-šal-bi-ra*).

```
BabMBSch1 r 6. x x (x) [n]i*-ši*-bi-ra ni-ir-ni
```

18'a

- **N:** u kabta | dullani | nušassak | [e]lni!
- **T:** and we shall take off (this) our heavy burden upon us.

- **L:** *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *kabta* ← kabtu I “f. *kabittu(m)* heavy”; *dullani* ← dullu I “pl. m. & f. trouble”; *nušassak* ← nasāku I “to throw (down)”; *[e]lni!* ← eli I “on, over, above”
- **Note:** [RN59aa: 173-74] interpret *x-ni-iš* at the end of the line as the end of an adverbial form, absent from the OB and SB versions.

```
BabMBSch1 r 7–8a. u₃# ka#–ab–ta dul#–la#–ni nu–ša!#–an–sa*#–ak?# | [e]l*#–ni <<iš>
```

18'b

- **N:** mālik (|) ilī | qurā[da]
- **T:** The counselor of the gods, the hero,
- **L:** *mālik* ← māliku I “adviser, counsellor”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *qurā[da]* ← qurādu I “hero, warrior of god, king, soldiers”

```
BabMBSch1 r 8b. ma–lik DINGIR–MEŠ qu₂#–ra#–[da]
```

19'

- **N:** alkāni | i niš[ši]ʾaššu | ina šu[b]t[īšu]
- **T:** Come, let us fetch him from [his] dwelling!
- **L:** *alkāni* ← alāku I “to go”; *i* ← i I “let's”; *niš[ši]ʾaššu* ← našû II “to lift, carry”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *šu[b]t[īšu]* ← šubtu I “seat, dwelling”

```
BabMBSch1 r 9. al–ka–ni i ni–iš–[ši]–a#–šu# i–na šu[b]–t[i–šu]
```

20'

- **N:** ellil | mālik (|) ilī | qu[rāda]
- **T:** Enlil, the counsellor of the gods, the hero,
- **L:** *ellil* ← Ellil I “”; *mālik* ← māliku I “adviser, counsellor”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *qu[rāda]* ← qurādu I “hero, warrior of god, king, soldiers”

```
BabMBSch1 r 10. {d}en–lil₂ ma–lik# DINGIR#–MEŠ# qu₂#–[ra–da]
```

21'a

- **N:** [alkāni | i nišši’aššu | ina šubtīšu]
- **T:** *Come, let us fetch him from his dwelling!*
- **L:** *[alkāni* ← alāku I “to go”; *i* ← i I “let's”; *nišši’aššu* ← našû II “to lift, carry”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *šubtīšu]* ← šubtu I “seat, dwelling”

```
BabMBSch1 r 11a. KI.MIN
```

21'b

- **N:** il[ū | išmû | zikiršu]
- **T:** The gods [*heard what he said*].
- **L:** *il[ū* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *išmû* ← šemû I “to hear”; *zikiršu]* ← zikru I “jB st. constr. *siqar* utterance”

```
BabMBSch1 r 11b. DINGIR-ME[Š x x x x x x]
```

22'

- **N:** u tupš[ikkīšunu | girra | ittakšū]
- **T:** [They put fire to their work] baskets.
- **L:** *u* ← u I “and, but, also”; *tupš[ikkīšunu* ← tupšikku I “pl. f. brick-carrying frame”; *girra* ← gīru I “fire(-god) O/jB as DN”; *ittakšū]* ← nakāšu I “to set aside OA, O/jB”

```
BabMBSch1 r 12. u₃# tup-ši-i[k-ki-šu-nu x x x x x x]
```

23'

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** …

```
BabMBSch1 r 13. x x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```